

Kretz Lumber AI Leadership Training

Step-by-Step Participant Handout and Facilitator Guide

Training location: Kretz Lumber, W11143 County Rd G, Antigo, WI 54409 | Time: 10:00 AM to 12:00 noon

Purpose of this handout

This handout supports the full two-hour leadership training. It follows the exact training outline and gives participants simple steps, practice prompts, reflection questions, governance checkpoints, prototype links, and external resources to continue learning after the session.

Core theme: AI creates opportunity, but it also creates responsibility.

Kretz example tools

Main examples page: willardwonder.github.io/kretz

Parcel / routing prototype: willardwonder.github.io/kretz/claudeparcel.html

Use these tools as discussion prototypes. They are not presented as production systems. The training should use them to ask: What value does this create? What data does it depend on? Who reviews the output? What policy would need to exist before daily use?

At-a-glance session flow

Training section	Participant action	Leadership question
1. Welcome and session framing	Identify where Kretz relies on experience, repeated communication, documentation, or informal knowledge.	Where could AI support work without replacing judgment?
2. What AI is and what it is not	Separate capabilities from limits: summarize, draft, classify, compare, analyze, but verify facts and decisions.	What should AI assist with, and what should it never decide alone?
3. Real-world AI impacts	Review success stories and AI failures using the News Break format.	What governance rule would have prevented the failure?
4. Current AI platforms and business uses	Match tools to business tasks: general assistants, copilots, research, creative, automation, data, industry AI.	Which tools would be approved for which kinds of work?
5. AI-created work products	Try prompts that turn rough notes into emails, summaries, checklists, training content, and decision support.	Who owns the final output?
6. Live demonstration	Observe the Kretz-focused prototypes and critique them as business tools.	Where is the value, and where is the risk?

7. Prompt vs. process activity	Compare a weak prompt with a stronger prompt that includes role, context, source material, constraints, and review.	How do we make good AI use repeatable?
8. Kretz AI opportunity and risk discussion	Score possible use cases by value, feasibility, data sensitivity, risk, and need for human review.	What should be piloted first?
9. Responsible AI adoption and governance	Draft guardrails for approved tools, data protection, human review, employee use, and accountability.	What has to be true before broader AI use is allowed?
10. Closing discussion and next steps	Choose next actions: policy, tools, teams, pilots, maintenance, adaptability.	Who owns AI exploration after today?

1. Welcome and session framing

Goal: Connect AI to the realities of Kretz Lumber rather than treating it as a generic technology trend.

- Write down one process that depends on repeated judgment or long-time employee knowledge.
- Write down one process that creates repeated emails, notes, summaries, checklists, or follow-ups.
- Write down one area where better consistency would help customers, employees, or leadership.

Try it prompt

Use the list below and identify three areas where AI could assist without replacing human judgment. For each area, explain the value, the risk, and the human review needed. Areas: [insert participant notes].

2. What AI is and what it is not

Goal: Understand AI as a work assistant that can generate, organize, summarize, classify, compare, and draft, while also recognizing that it can be wrong, incomplete, or overconfident.

AI can often help with	AI should not be trusted alone for
Summaries, first drafts, meeting notes, checklists, brainstorming, training questions, plain-language explanations, data pattern review.	Final legal, financial, safety, HR, customer, technical, or operational decisions without human review.

Try it prompt

Create a two-column table showing what AI could help with in a lumber, forestry, or manufacturing business and what would still require human review. Keep it practical and specific.

3. Real-world AI impacts: News Break activity

Goal: Use real business failures to show why governance matters. For each story, ask what rule, owner, review step, or tool control would have reduced the risk.

News Break	What happened	Leadership lesson
Air Canada chatbot	A customer relied on incorrect bereavement fare information from an airline chatbot, and the company was held responsible for misleading information from its site.	Customer-facing AI represents the company.
Mata v. Avianca	Attorneys submitted fake legal cases generated by ChatGPT and were sanctioned.	AI can sound confident and still be wrong.
Samsung data leakage	Employees reportedly entered sensitive source code and meeting notes into public AI tools, leading to restrictions.	Employees need clear data rules before they use AI.
DPD chatbot	A delivery company disabled part of its chatbot after it swore, criticized the company, and went viral.	Uncontrolled AI can become brand risk.
iTutorGroup hiring	The EEOC alleged hiring software automatically rejected older applicants; the company settled.	AI in HR decisions creates legal and fairness risk.
CNET AI articles	AI-generated articles required corrections after factual and mathematical errors were identified.	Published AI content needs human review.

News Break worksheet

- Which AI failure feels most realistic for Kretz?
- What data or decision was at risk?
- What human review step was missing?
- What policy would prevent a similar problem?
- Should this use case be allowed, restricted, or prohibited?

4. Current AI platforms and business uses

Goal: Understand that AI is not one product. Different AI tools support different kinds of work.

Tool category	Examples	High-value use
General AI assistants	ChatGPT, Claude, Gemini	Drafting, summarizing, brainstorming, planning, analysis.
Workplace copilots	Microsoft 365 Copilot, Google Workspace Gemini	Email, documents, meetings, spreadsheets, search.
Research tools	Perplexity, NotebookLM, deep research tools	Source comparison, document review, research support.
Creative tools	Canva AI, Adobe Firefly, image/video tools	Training visuals, customer education, safety posters, marketing drafts.
Automation tools	Power Automate, Zapier, Copilot Studio	Forms, routing, task creation, notifications, workflow support.

Data and analytics tools	Excel Copilot, Power BI, data analysis features	Trends, reporting, operations data, sales summaries.
Industry-specific AI	Scanning, defect detection, route optimization, forestry analytics	Quality, logistics, land identification, process support.

Activity

Pick one tool category and identify one task it could support at Kretz. Then identify what data it would need and what review would be required.

5. Examples of AI-created work products

Goal: Practice using AI to turn rough information into usable business outputs. These examples are intentionally practical and low-risk when fictional or sanitized data is used.

Practice task	Prompt starter
Landowner follow-up email	Draft a professional follow-up email from these notes. Do not invent facts. Separate confirmed information from items requiring review.
Safety toolbox talk	Create a five-minute toolbox talk based on this near-miss scenario. Include risk, safe practices, and discussion questions.
Meeting summary	Turn these rough notes into decisions, open questions, action items, and suggested next steps.
Customer inquiry response	Draft a response that is helpful but does not confirm pricing, availability, or suitability unless provided.
SOP-to-training quiz	Turn this approved procedure into a five-question training quiz with an answer key.
Decision-support summary	Compare these options by value, risk, assumptions, and information still needed.

6. Live demonstration: Kretz prototype walkthrough

Goal: Show what becomes possible when AI-style tools are connected to realistic Kretz problems.

Prototype A: Fleet routing tool

- Open the Kretz example site and launch the parcel/routing prototype.
- Enter or review a few pickup/drop-off locations.
- Observe how the tool organizes route planning information.
- Ask: What would make this useful for real operations?
- Ask: What data quality, map accuracy, privacy, and review issues would need to be managed?

[Link: Fleet routing / parcel prototype](#)

Prototype B: Land identification and outreach tool

- Use the tool or demonstration scenario to identify potential land opportunities.
- Generate a draft outreach email.
- Review the email for tone, accuracy, assumptions, and overpromising.
- Ask: Who should approve outreach before it is sent?
- Ask: What data sources would need validation?

[Link: Kretz example tools page](#)

7. Prompt vs. process activity

Goal: Show that strong AI results come from a clear process, not just a better tool.

Weak prompt

Write an email about forest management.

Stronger prompt

You are helping a professional forester draft a follow-up email to a private landowner. Use only the notes below. Do not invent facts. Separate confirmed information from items requiring follow-up. Use a professional, practical, respectful tone. Include a thank-you opening, summary of goals, possible next steps, questions still needing review, and a clear closing. Notes: [insert notes].

Debrief

- What context made the second prompt better?
- What guardrails reduced risk?
- What would still require expert review?
- How could this prompt structure be reused for sales, safety, operations, or training?

8. Kretz AI opportunity and risk map

Goal: Identify AI opportunities and immediately evaluate them for value and risk.

Use case	Value 1-5	Ease 1-5	Data sensitivity	Human review needed	Governance rule needed
Meeting summaries			Low/Med/High	Low/Med/High	
Sales follow-up drafts			Low/Med/High	Low/Med/High	
Landowner communication drafts			Low/Med/High	Low/Med/High	
Safety toolbox talks			Low/Med/High	Low/Med/High	
Maintenance log summaries			Low/Med/High	Low/Med/High	
Fleet routing support			Low/Med/High	Low/Med/High	
Land research and outreach			Low/Med/High	Low/Med/High	

9. Responsible AI adoption and governance

Goal: Give leadership a practical starting point for policies, procedures, approved tools, and accountability.

Minimum governance checklist

Governance area	Decision Kretz should make
Approved tools	Which AI tools are approved for employees, leaders, and pilots?
Data rules	What data is public, internal, confidential, customer-sensitive, employee-sensitive, or prohibited?
Human review	Which outputs require expert review before being used or shared?
Customer-facing use	Can AI draft customer communication? Can it respond directly? Who approves it?
Safety, HR, legal, financial use	Which uses require stricter review or are not allowed?
Ownership	Who owns policy, tool approval, training, support, and pilot decisions?
Monitoring	How will pilots be evaluated, updated, paused, or retired?
Adaptability	How often will tools, policy, and procedures be reviewed as AI changes?

Governance sorting activity

Sort each use into one of four categories: allowed with public AI, allowed only with approved company AI, requires human review, or should not be done with AI at this time.

- Drafting a generic thank-you email.
- Summarizing confidential pricing information.
- Creating a safety procedure from scratch.
- Drafting a customer follow-up from approved notes.
- Uploading employee performance information.
- Generating a training quiz from an approved SOP.
- Asking AI to decide whether to harvest a specific property.
- Entering customer contract terms into a free chatbot.

10. Closing discussion and next steps

Goal: Turn the session into a practical path forward.

Next step	Suggested action
Develop governance policy and procedure	Create a short AI use policy that explains approved tools, prohibited data, required review, and accountability.
Select tools	Choose approved tools for general use, research, workplace productivity, automation, and prototypes.
Define teams	Create a small AI working group with leadership, operations, forestry, sales, HR/training, IT/security, and finance input.

Select pilots	Start with small, practical, low-risk workflows tied to real business value.
Develop and maintain solutions	Assign owners to test, improve, document, train, and support useful tools.
Stay adaptable	Review tools, risks, policy, and workflows regularly because the technology landscape will keep changing.

Exit ticket

- One AI use case that could create value at Kretz:
- One risk that must be managed first:
- One governance rule that should exist before broader adoption:
- One team or owner who should be involved next:

External resources and references

Use these links for continued learning, examples, and governance planning.

Resource	Use it for	Link
NIST AI Risk Management Framework	Governance structure and risk language	nist.gov AI RMF
NIST Generative AI Profile	GenAI-specific risks and controls	NIST GenAI Profile
CISA Artificial Intelligence	AI cybersecurity and data security guidance	cisa.gov/ai
Microsoft Responsible AI Standard	Example of a responsible AI framework from a major vendor	Microsoft Responsible AI
OpenAI Enterprise Privacy	Understanding enterprise AI data controls	OpenAI Enterprise Privacy
Anthropic Claude Trust Center	Vendor trust and safety information	Anthropic Trust Center
Google AI Principles	Major vendor AI principles and responsible use	Google AI Principles
Air Canada chatbot case	Customer-facing AI liability lesson	Guardian article
DPD chatbot incident	Brand and customer service risk lesson	Guardian article
Mata v. Avianca court order	Hallucination and verification lesson	Court order summary
EEOC iTutorGroup settlement	AI hiring and discrimination risk lesson	EEOC release

Note: For organizational use, external examples and resources should be reviewed periodically because AI tools, vendor terms, legal expectations, and security guidance change quickly.